

# Managing an Inclusive Team

Build a team where everyone gives their best

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice — by EvaTalk

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## BEFORE YOU BEGIN

# Build a team where everyone gives their best

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You manage a team and you want it to be truly inclusive — where diversity is an asset and everyone feels safe to contribute. But inclusion can't be decreed: it's built, through concrete practices.

This guide helps you examine your own managerial reflexes, create psychological safety, and put inclusive practices in place day to day.

### Your intention

A situation where you'd like your team to be more inclusive: \_\_\_\_\_

## The 4 approaches

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This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

**Psychodynamic** — understand the root.

**CBT** — ease the negative thoughts.

**Humanistic** — reconcile with yourself.

**Systemic** — act on your environment.

## Your style & blind spots

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Inclusive managing starts with knowing yourself: your relationship to authority, whom you spontaneously value, to whom you give the floor or opportunities without realizing. We all have blind spots.

Looking at them isn't accusing yourself: it's the condition for managing more fairly.

### *Example*

*Sure he was fair, Marc noticed he always gave the visible projects to the same people. Seeing it let him rebalance.*

### **My managerial blind spots**

To whom do I spontaneously give the floor, projects, recognition? Whom do I overlook?

### **My style**

What's my relationship to authority, conflict, difference? Where does it come from?

→ *Seeing my blind spots is the start of fairer managing.*

## Moving past automatic reactions

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'I treat everyone the same, so it's fair': yet equity isn't uniformity — treating different situations the same can be unfair. And fear of 'getting it wrong' sometimes leads to inaction.

Equity means meeting real needs.

### *Example*

*Inès thought she was right to 'not see differences'. Recognizing each person's specific needs made her team fairer.*

### **Equity ≠ uniformity**

Note a situation where treating people 'the same' may not have been equitable.

### **Reframe**

Turn 'I might get it wrong' into 'I can adjust, listen, correct'.

→ *Equity meets real needs — not identical treatment for all.*

## Psychological safety

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An inclusive team rests on psychological safety: everyone can speak, make mistakes, be different, without fear. The manager is its first guarantor — by example.

What you embody weighs more than what you decree.

### *Example*

*By admitting her own mistakes in meetings, Sofia freed up her team's voice. Ideas poured in.*

### **My team's climate**

Does everyone dare to speak, say no, flag a mistake? Who stays silent?

### **My example**

What stance can I embody to make mistakes and difference safe?

→ *Psychological safety is created first by the manager's example.*

## Concrete inclusive practices

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Inclusion is built through practices: equitable speaking turns, objective criteria (hiring, evaluation, promotion), regular and fair feedback, amplifying quiet voices, flexibility (parenting, disability, religion), and measuring (who speaks, who progresses).

What gets measured improves.

### *Example*

*By introducing a systematic round-the-table, Léa saw ideas emerge from those who'd stayed silent.*

### **My practices**

Pick 2 practices to introduce (speaking turns, clear criteria, fair feedback...).

### **What I measure**

What will I observe to check inclusion (who speaks, who's promoted, who leaves)?

→ *Inclusion is proven by practices and results, not intentions.*

## Practical tips & advice

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### Tips & advice

- Introduce speaking turns: so quiet voices exist too.
- Set objective criteria in hiring, evaluation, promotion (against bias).
- Watch interruptions: who cuts off whom? redirect tactfully.
- Give regular, fair feedback to everyone, not just 'favourites'.
- Offer flexibility (parenting, disability, religion, time zones): inclusion is concrete.
- Measure: who speaks, who progresses, who leaves — numbers reveal blind spots.



# To fill in

My team

| Person | Has space to contribute? | An action to include them |
|--------|--------------------------|---------------------------|
|        |                          |                           |
|        |                          |                           |
|        |                          |                           |
|        |                          |                           |
|        |                          |                           |

My inclusive practices

| Practice to introduce | What I measure |
|-----------------------|----------------|
|                       |                |
|                       |                |
|                       |                |
|                       |                |
|                       |                |

## PLAN

# Your 4-week plan

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**Week 1** — See my blind spots.

**Week 2** — Equity  $\neq$  uniformity.

**Week 3** — Create psychological safety.

**Week 4** — Put concrete practices in place.

### Your plan in 3 lines

- The blind spot I watch:
- The inclusive practice I introduce:
- What I measure:

TO CLOSE

# **An inclusive team is built, practice by practice.**

*With clarity and commitment. Practices, not intentions.*

*This guide is a reflection and managerial coaching tool — not a certified training or HR legal advice. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.*